



The New Year Values Week

An assembly on the first day of the spring term, then five minutes of form time each morning: gratitude, ambition, resilience and courage, one a day. Every student ends the week with one small goal, a plan and a first step, and a sheet they fill in every Friday until half term.

Not “new year, new me”. The week is about being grateful for what you already have, wanting to get a little better at one thing, and keeping going when it gets hard. Small goals that build up, not a big start that falls over by February.

Print these

What	What it is
The student sheet	Two pages, printed double-sided: the week on the front, the Friday tracker on the back. One per student.
Page 2 of this pack	The week, day by day, with what to say each morning, and the research behind the assembly. For you.

How it works

When	What you do	Slides
Monday	Run the assembly, about ten minutes. Then in form time, hand out the sheets and get names on them.	1 to 11
Tuesday to Friday	Five minutes each morning, one value a day. Each has one slide and one box on the sheet.	12 to 15
Every Friday	Two minutes: one line on the back of the sheet about what they actually did.	16
Last Friday before half term	Students read the whole sheet and answer the three questions at the bottom.	17

Worth knowing

- Keep the sheets in a folder in the form room between Fridays, or most will not survive to half term.
- Goals stay private unless a student wants to share. Steer them away from weight, food and how they look, and if a goal worries you, speak to the student and your head of year.
- Gratitude can be hard for a student who is having a difficult time. Anything counts, however small, and nobody has to read theirs out.
- If your term starts on a Tuesday, run the assembly that day and move each value along by one. Courage lands on the Monday after.
- If your form already uses By Half Term, this sheet does the same job for the spring term, so you only need one of them.

More free assemblies and form time activities are on the way. Follow @thepastoralguide to hear when they land.





The week, day by day

Five minutes each morning. Each day says what happens and what you might say.

Day	What happens	What you might say
Monday	The assembly. Then hand out the sheets, names on, and collect them into a folder.	"This isn't about a new you. It's about getting a bit better at one thing."
Tuesday: gratitude	Slide 12. Three things that went well last term, and one person who helped.	"Small things count. Finishing a book counts."
Wednesday: ambition	Slide 13. One thing to get better at by half term, made small enough to start this week.	"Could you start it this week? If not, make it smaller."
Thursday: resilience	Slide 14. The first step, and a plan: when this happens, I will do that.	"What usually gets in the way? Plan for that."
Friday: courage	Slide 15. Take the first step, write the date, and pick one person to ask how it is going.	"Starting something small can feel a bit silly. Do it anyway."
Every Friday	Slide 16. One line on the back: what they actually did that week.	"A blank week isn't a fail. Write what you'll do next week."
Last Friday before half term	Slide 17. Read the whole sheet and answer the three questions.	"What will you keep doing after half term?"

The research behind the slides

Slide	What it found	Source
4	Students used a university gym 47% more as a new term started, 33% more at the start of a week and 12% more at the start of a year.	Dai, Milkman and Riis (2014), Management Science
5	Of over 1,000 people in Sweden, 59% kept a goal to start or do more of something a year later, against 47% for a goal to stop or avoid something.	Oscarsson and colleagues (2020), PLOS ONE
6	Across 94 studies, people who made an if-then plan reached their goals more often, a medium to large effect.	Gollwitzer and Sheeran (2006), Advances in Experimental Social Psychology
7	New habits took 66 days on average to feel automatic, and missing one day made very little difference.	Lally and colleagues (2010), European Journal of Social Psychology
12	221 middle school students who wrote down what they were grateful for felt more satisfied with school, and still did three weeks later.	Froh, Sefick and Emmons (2008), Journal of School Psychology

